

THE RISE OF SMARTPHONE PHOTOGRAPHY

They say the best camera is the one that's with you. And what could make a better camera than the humble smartphone that is with us all the time.

The camera on our smartphones has become as much an inseparable part of our lives as the smartphone itself. We never thought we would but we have come to rely on it so much these days that it's become impossible to imagine owning a phone with a camera.

Things weren't always like this, though. Wind the clocks back by about ten years and remember what it was like back then. Cameras had just started making an appearance on phones and only the most expensive models had them. It wasn't often that you'd come across someone with a smartphone, first of all, much less someone with a camera on their phone.

The cameras on phones back, to quite an extent, were a gimmick and a bit of a joke. The popular resolution back then was CIF, with the more expensive models having a VGA resolution camera, which was just enough pixels to be able to distinguish a person from a tree. As usual, though, reso-